



ABOUT ME:

Hi, my name is Nico Swenson, a local drag artist, writer, and designer. Most people know me by my alter ego Miss Texas 1988. As Texas you can find me performing, hosting, and producing events around the city. In or out of drag I am a political advocate and community builder. As a writer I cover local arts and culture. As a designer, I strive to use my art to help other people’s visions be realized, especially in ways that help promote a creative, functional society for all.

The Drag Side

Currently you can find merampaging around town in my Queen form Miss Texas 1988 or my King side JohnJacobJingle-HeimerSH!T as a cast member of TUSH at Clock-out Lounge
The Sunday Sip at Red Star in Tacoma
Jawbreaker at Unicorn
Lashes at Unicorn
Host/producer of High F@ggotry at Unicorn
and as a collective member of the roaming show Glory Hole

When not at those locations, I’ve been spotted performing at Lumen Field, The Space Needle, Showbox Downtown and SODO, The Seattle Art Museum, and even as a painting at SeaTac Airport.

Oh! I also won a tv show... Check out Camp Wannakiki Season 5 on OutTV!



Writing

While Texas Bops around in front of the camera as a reporter for The [Stranger’s social media](#), Nico covers local art as a [regular columnist](#). I’ve had the honor of interviewing local celebs like Dina Martina, covering the successes of our home town champions like Jane Don’t, and highlight the city’s extreme talent from dance, to puppetry.

Design!

My most recent adventure has been tackling a degree in graphic design through Seattle Central Creative Academy. Through the program I have gained new skills and interests in print, branding, systems thinking, motion graphics, and really wacky photoshop-ping.



Let’s look at some highlight projects

THOT BUBBLES
Ma(gay)zine

One of my proudest achievements in design was creating and producing a 60 page magazine to highlight PNW queer culture past and present. With co-editor D. Smith, *Thot Bubbles* combines poetry, painting, interviews with Seattle icons, essays on queer landscapes, and interactive twists to put your own self into the pages.

Over the course of 9 months, my role was to cultivate detailed moodboards, style guides, and well researched content to build a n expressive yet cohesive product. With careful precision, many rounds of edits, and funding from Seattle Office of Arts and Culture, *Thot Bubbles* coalesced into printed form.

To supplement it’s launch, I utilized other assignments to build out the brand. A custom point of purchase was designed and built using collaged images from past queer community events.

Mockups of potential parties were built in photoshop to ideate the gathering of community and the environmental design components that could expand content from page to pop-up. Ultimately, a launch party took place that tangibly manifested the ma(gay)zine’s goal: To unite contemporary faggotry with the queer history it originated.

